

TOOL 5 • CULTURAL ARCHITECTURE

The Leadership Behavioral Contract

Operating Standard: Systems guide the work, but habits sustain the system. This contract formalizes the six non-negotiable leadership behaviors required to eliminate organizational drift.

THE 6 CORE LEADERSHIP COMMITMENTS		
LEADERSHIP HABIT	THE OPERATING STANDARD	THE SELF-AUDIT TEST
1. Direct Feedback with Respect	Say the hard thing early within 48 hours. No hallway meetings after the meeting.	Does the person know exactly what observable behavior must change tomorrow?
2. Explicit Priorities & Trade-offs	State what is NOT a priority. Enforce the One-In, One-Out Kill Switch.	If everything slipped except one deliverable, does the team know what survives?
3. Process-Driven Autopsies	Diagnose the system, not the person. Fix the root cause, not the quarterly symptom.	What process, intake rule, or handoff broke before the individual failed?
4. Radical Context Transparency	Say what you know, what you don't know, and what might change. No PR spin.	Are people hearing business truths from leadership or through hallway rumors?
5. End-to-End Customer Ownership	Eliminate departmental turf wars. Optimize across seams, not within functional silos.	Would a customer care about our internal excuse, or did we drop the promise?
6. Capacity & Focus Protection	Eliminate spreadsheet heroics. Match incoming workload to realistic frontline capacity.	Are our top performers penalized with infinite work because they are reliable?

LEADERSHIP TEAM PUBLIC SIGN-OFF & ADOPTION

"We, the leadership team, publicly commit to holding one another accountable to these six standards. We will challenge drift constructively and model these behaviors daily."

Leader Name & Title

Leader Name & Title

Leader Name & Title

Leader Name & Title

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